ROSS CARTER

LEAD SOFTWARE ENGINEER

CONTACT

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KEY SKILLS

LANGUAGES

Java (8-25)
Gradle
Maven
Kotlin
Python
JavaScript
TypeScript

FRAMEWORKS & LIBRARIES

Spring Framework
Spring Boot
React
Angular

CLOUD & DEVOPS

AWS
ECS
Lambda
AWS Glue
SageMaker
Docker
Jenkins
GitLab CI
AWS CodePipeline
SonarQube

ARCHITECTURE

Microservices
Event-Driven Architecture
Cloud-Native Applications

PROFILE

Lead Software Engineer with 10+ years of experience designing and delivering scalable cloud-native applications, microservices, and AI-powered solutions across FMCG, automotive, retail, and technology sectors.

Specialist in Java, Spring Boot, AWS, cloud architecture, machine learning integration, and high-performance backend systems. Proven track record leading engineering teams, modernising platforms, establishing engineering best practices, and delivering award-winning digital products used by millions of customers globally.

Combines deep technical expertise with strong stakeholder management skills, enabling the translation of complex business requirements into scalable, commercially valuable technology solutions.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Grew Diageo's FlavorPrint personalisation platform from 400,000 to more than 70 million consumer flavour profiles.
- Delivered award-winning AI-powered marketing products recognised by Campaign Tech Awards and The Drum Marketing Awards.
- Designed and deployed high-volume AI advertising services processing millions of requests daily with sub-200ms response times.
- Increased automated test coverage from 0% to over 80% across engineering portfolios, significantly improving software quality and release confidence.
- Led development of cloud-native AWS platforms using Java, Spring Boot, SageMaker, Lambda and microservices architectures.

CURRENT EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

LEAD SOFTWARE ENGINEER • SEPT 2025 TO PRESENT
SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER • NOV 2022 TO SEPT 2025

Diageo – Central London

- Architected and delivered multiple greenfield cloud-native services supporting global marketing teams, improving scalability, maintainability, and speed of delivery.
- Led the evolution of FlavorPrint into a reusable AI-driven personalisation platform spanning whisky, beer, tequila, cocktails and food recommendations.

REST APIs
Distributed Systems

DATABASES
MongoDB
DynamoDB
SQL

AI & MACHINE LEARNING
Machine Learning Engineering
LLM Development
Prompt Engineering
AI-Powered Personalisation
AWS SageMaker

TESTING & QUALITY ENGINEERING
Playwright
Automated Testing
CI/CD
TDD

EDUCATION

First Class Honours at Edge Hill University (Games Programming)
2014 – 2017

PERSONAL PROJECTS

- Driving Instructor Website (2025 - Present)
- Wedding Website (2021)
- BBC Games Engineer Internship (2017)
- Games Jams (2016/17)
- Barclays Tech Challenge (2016)

- Development of Java and Spring Boot microservices on Amazon ECS using MongoDB and AWS Sagemaker. Developed and deployed machine-learning endpoints and modernized the APIs from Java 11/Spring 5 to Java 25/Spring Boot 4.
- What's Your Cocktail won "Best Use of AI" at the Campaign Tech Awards 2025 and Gold for Data/Insight at The Drum Marketing Awards 2025.
- Introduced software engineering governance frameworks including pull request reviews, Architecture Decision Records (ADRs), and enhanced technical documentation, improving code quality, maintainability, and cross-team collaboration.

PREVIOUS EXPERIENCE

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER • OCT 2020 – NOV 2022

Jaguar Land Rover – Manchester

- Developed and enhanced microservices supporting connected vehicle infotainment platforms used across multiple vehicle programmes.
- Led software delivery activities across release cycles, coordinating development, testing, deployment readiness, and stakeholder communication.
- Managed and mentored a team of four software engineers, driving performance, career development and engineering excellence.
- Provided production support for business-critical services, leading incident investigation, root cause analysis and service improvement initiatives.

SOFTWARE ENGINEER • AUG 2017 – OCT 2020

Quarte Retail Group (QVC) – Liverpool

- Designed and developed RESTful APIs and enterprise applications supporting European retail operations within a globally distributed engineering environment.
- Delivered integration solutions that improved operational efficiency, data flow reliability and business process automation.
- Collaborated closely with product, engineering and business stakeholders to deliver scalable and customer-focused technology solutions.

GAMES ENGINEER • APR 2016 – AUG 2017

CyberGaTE – Liverpool

- Developed and designed an educational cyber security game designed to teach common workplace security risks and prevention strategies.